Compare and round parachute measures

A Coffee Filter Parachute

Name _____ Date _____

Write one answer in each blank. For comparisons, also put >, <, or = in the circle.

1. Across several drops, a flat filter floats for 42 counted seconds in all and a crumpled filter for 28. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What is the greater total?

42 ○ 28

Show your thinking.

2. One set of parachute strings is 76 centimeters long and another is 67 centimeters. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What is the greater length?

76 ○ 67

Show your thinking.

3. Big and Little each record 48 test drops. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What is the shared number when the totals are equal?

48 ○ 48

Show your thinking.

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4. The supply box holds 23 paperclips. What is 23 rounded to the nearest ten?

23 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

5. A piece of string is 57 centimeters long. What is 57 rounded to the nearest ten?

57 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

6. A safe standing-height drop is measured as 95 centimeters. What is 95 rounded to the nearest ten?

95 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

Gravity and drag

Gravity pulls the parachute down. Moving air pushes back with air resistance, or drag, slowing the fall without stopping gravity.

Wide meets air

The flat filter and crumpled filter weigh the same. The wide shape meets more air, makes more drag, and falls more slowly.

Change the weight

With the same canopy and strings, two paperclips add weight. In air, that parachute usually reaches the floor sooner.

A fair test

Change one thing at a time, keep the others equal, and measure several drops. Repeating helps a result become more trustworthy.

A steadier fall

A tiny hole at the canopy top lets some air through. The flow can become more even, so the parachute wobbles less.

The same big idea

Human and space-lander parachutes use wide canopies too. Gravity pulls down while drag pushes against motion and slows the descent.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

WONDER DAILY

A Coffee Filter Parachute

Write a fair-test note

A Coffee Filter Parachute · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose one clue. Say your idea first, then draw or write it.



Wide catches more air



One change at a time



A steadier path

Draw one parachute test and add a small arrow to the part you changed.

gravity · air · air resistance · drag · canopy · surface area · weight · fair test · predict · measure

The wide filter fell more slowly because … dictate how it meets the air

To make the test fair, I would … dictate what stays the same

The tiny top hole may … dictate how the fall changes

Does your sentence name one change and explain what you would predict or measure?